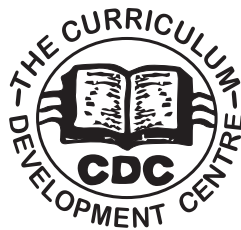




Republic of Zambia
Ministry of Education

MUSICAL ARTS EDUCATION TEACHING MODULE

FORM 1 - TERM 2



Developed by the Curriculum Development Centre
Lusaka
2025

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Preface

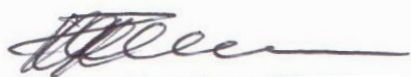
The **Musical Arts Education (MAE) Teaching Module** for **Form 1** has been developed in response to the introduction of the **Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC)**, a transformative initiative aimed at enhancing quality education and relevance.

This teaching module is designed to support teachers to effectively deliver Musical Arts Education lessons under the new curriculum. Its primary objectives are to, bridge the gap created by the absence of approved textbooks and equip teachers with practical skills and assessments tailored to learners' needs and levels.

The Ministry of Education acknowledges the challenges associated with transitioning to a new curriculum. Consequently, this module reflects our commitment to providing teachers with structured guidance, suggested activities, formative and summative assessments aligned with the CBC's objectives.

While this module serves as a foundational resource, we encourage teachers to supplement it with their own research and innovations to address potential gaps during implementation. The suggested activities and assessments are designed to foster practical and critical thinking skills in learners, ensuring relevance and adaptability across diverse school contexts.

Teachers are encouraged to tailor these suggestions to their unique classroom dynamics and explore alternative approaches when necessary. We hope this module will empower teachers to navigate the new competence-based curriculum with confidence, inspiring and equipping learners with applied knowledge, skills, and values.



Kelvin Mambwe (PhD)
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Acknowledgement

The **Musical Arts Education Teaching Module** for **Form 1** is the culmination of a collaborative and inclusive development process. I wish to extend my profound appreciation to individuals, institutions, and organisations that contributed to the module's development, their invaluable input and expertise have enriched the content and quality of this teaching module.

I also acknowledge the dedication and hard work of the staff at the Curriculum Development Centre, whose tireless efforts ensured the successful completion of the teaching module development process.



Charles Ndakala (Dr.)
Director - Curriculum Development
MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

Introduction

The Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC) is designed to equip learners with competences necessary to navigate the complexities of the modern world. This Musical Arts Education (MAE) teaching module is tailored to support teachers in implementing the CBC, focusing on the attainment of specific competences of specified sub-topics as indicated in the syllabus, but aligned to the general competences like creativity and innovation, critical thinking, problem-solving, and effective communication.

Each specific competence is supported by carefully designed learning activities that cater for diverse learning styles and abilities. These learning activities further give guidance on how they should be effectively administered to the learners to meet the expected standards that speak to the specific competences. Furthermore, this module encourages teachers to assess learners' progress using a range of strategies.

By using this MAE teaching module, teachers will be able to support learners to acquire competences outlined in the syllabus. This will enable the development of practical skills, enhancement of talents, creativity, self-expression and sense of aesthetics among learners.

Icons used in the module



Summary



Terminology



Assessment



Tips



Activity



Discussion

TOPIC: 1.5 MELODY

Introduction

This topic is broken down into two subtopics which are: 1.5.1 Melodic motion and 1.5.2 Simple melody writing.

What is Melody?

Melody is a fundamental element of music often considered the most memorable part of a song or composition. It is the backbone of music, the thread that weaves together pitches, rhythms, and emotions to create a rich blend of sound. It is defined as the succession of pitches heard in a sequence, creating a musical line or theme.

Melody has practical application in various aspects of life, such as composing jingles and advertisements to make products more memorable. It can be used in therapy, evoke emotions, improve mood and aid cognitive development.

General Competences:

Learners should acquire the following general Competences:

Analytical thinking: Ability to systematically examine, interpret and evaluate musical elements and structures, for purpose of applying them in addressing social-economical needs.

Creativity and innovation: Ability to experiment new approaches and generate musical ideas that exhibit originality and take creative risks in the composition, performance and interpretation of music.

Critical thinking: Ability to analyse, investigate and evaluate musical works, performances and practices with a discerning and reflective mindset to address social-economical needs.

Collaboration: Ability to work effectively with others in various musical setting such as ensembles or bands and other music projects to achieve goals in Musical Arts Education.

Communication: Ability to express and convey musical ideas appropriately, clearly and effectively (verbal and non-verbal).

Emotional intelligence: Ability to recognise, understand, express and manage emotional stress in oneself and others through musical activities.

Problem solving: Ability to use music to identify, analyse and address social-economical challenges and obstacles.



TERMINOLOGY

Antecedent: The first part of a melodic phrase that sets up a musical idea, often ending in uncertainty, to be resolved by the consequent.

Conjunct motion: Smooth, stepwise movement between, consecutive pitches in a melody e.g. (C-D-E).

Contour: The overall shape or pattern of ups and downs in pitch, creating a unique outline or topography.

Disjunct motion: Movement between consecutive pitches in a melody by larger intervals, often creating a sense of leap or jump, e.g. (C-E, C-G)

Hill: This refers to a musical phrase or section that gradually rise in pitch, often creating a sense of tension, anticipation or build up.

- Melody:** A succession of pitches in rhythm, heard in sequence, creating a musical line that convey emotion, structure and character.
- Melodic devices:** Techniques used by composers to create interest, variety and emotional impact in a melody.
- Motif:** A short, repeated pattern or idea, often just a few notes, that is used to build a melody or tune.
- Motion:** The way pitches move in relation to each other, either smoothly (conjunct) or by leaps (disjunct).
- Phrase:** A group of notes that form a complete musical thought or idea, similar to a sentence in language
- Valley:** refers to a musical phrase or section that descends in pitch, often creating a sense of relaxation, resolution, or calmness.
- Wave:** A musical phrase or section that moves in a wave like motion.

Sub-Topic: 1.5.1. Melodic Motion

Introduction

This subtopic focuses on two types of melodic motion, as well as identifies melodic shape. Melodic motion refers to the way pitches in rhythm move in relation to each other within a melody, creating a sense of progression and direction.

There are two types of melodic motion: conjunct motion, which proceeds by step from one scale degree to the next (i.e., by the interval of a 2nd), and disjunct motion, which proceeds by leap (i.e., by intervals larger than a 2nd)

Specific Competence 1.5.1 Describe the melodic motion.

Suggested Methodology: Demonstration and individual activities ...

Learning Environment Setup: Any environment such as, (an outdoor), artificial (music room...) and technological (video, YouTube...)

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Piano/keyboard, guitars, visual aids such as charts...



LEARNING ACTIVITIES

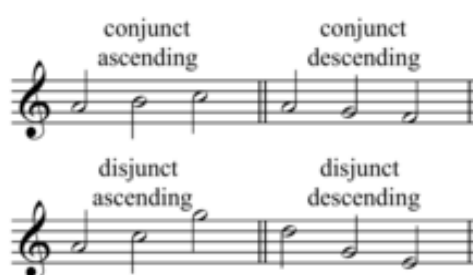
Activity 1: Identifying conjunct and disjunct motion in a melody.

Task 1: Learners to sing any familiar melodies (e.g. Row, row, row your boat) and identify different intervals between the notes of the melody.



Engage learners in singing different melodies and identify conjunct and disjunct motion in the melodies.

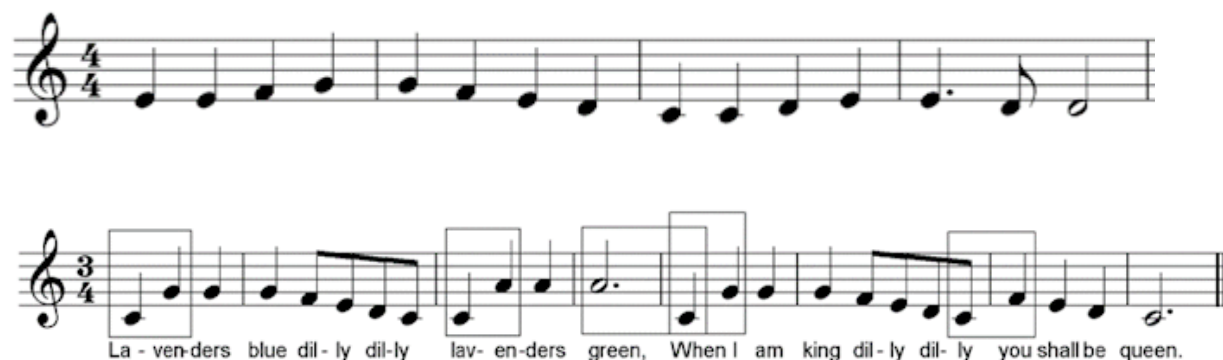
Task 2: Play some notes like these below on the keyboard and ask learners in groups to identify them as either conjunct or disjunct motion.



Divide learners in groups and ask them to identify different notes played on the keyboard as either conjunct or disjunct motion.



- Learners in groups to analyse the given melodies below and identify conjunct and disjunct motion.



Activity 2: Identifying the shape/contour of the melody. (valleys, waves, hill ...)

Task 1: Learners listen or sing simple common melodies then identify what a valley, wave or a hill.



TIP

Learners to freely explore and identify the shape/contour of different melodies with clear examples of valley, waves and hills.

Examples of a valley contour:

- Twinkle, Little Star. The melody starts high, descends to a low point, and then ascends again, creating a valley shape.

Wave Contour:

- London Bridge is Falling Down. This traditional children's song has a melody that oscillates up and down creating a wave-like contour.
- The Wheels on the Bus: The melody of this children's song features a wave like pattern, with a repetitive motion that mimics the action of the bus parts.

Hill Contour:

- Happy Birthday to You: The melody starts low, rises to a high point and then descends slightly, forming a hill contour.
- Jingle Bells: The melody starts low, ascends to high point and then remains relatively high, creating a hill shape.

Expected Standard: Melodic motion describe correctly.



ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

- Provide learners with printed melodies and ask them to identify and label they valleys, waves and hills.
- Give learners a melody with missing notes and ask them to complete the melody by adding notes that create a specific contour.
- Play a series of melodies with different contours and ask learners to identify the type of contour used in each melody.
- Look at the following melody, taken from the popular song “This is What You Came For” by Calvin Harris and Rihanna which uses a mix of conjunct and disjunct melodic movement. Study the melody and then answer the questions below as a class exercise.



- a. In which two bars of the song does the melody move by disjunct movement?
- b. In which two bars of the song does the melody move by conjunct movement?
- c. What is the note name of the lowest pitch note in this melody? d) Identify the note name of the highest pitch note in this melody?
- d. Measure the interval between the lowest and highest note



SUMMARY

This subtopic has highlighted the following:

- Melodic motion refers to the movement of pitches in a melody.
- There are two main types of melodic motion, and these are conjunct and disjunct motion.
- The overall shape or pattern of ups and downs in pitch creating a unique outline or topography is referred to as a contour.
- There are many types of melodic contours in music apart from valleys, waves and hill.
- A valley refers to a musical phrase or section that descends in pitch, often creating a sense of relaxation, resolution, or calmness.
- A wave is a musical phrase or section that moves in a wave like motion.
- A hill refers to a musical phrase or section that gradually rise in pitch, often creating a sense of tension, anticipation or build up.

Sub Topic:1.5.2. Simple Melody Writing

Introduction

The main aim of this sub-topic is to look at how to compose simple melodies using a motif, as an antecedent (question) and then provide the consequent (answer) with limited range of notes and rhythmic patterns.

Simple melody writing refers to the process or technique of creating a short, coherent, and memorable musical idea using pitch and rhythm, to convey emotion and mood.

Specific Competence: 1.5.2.1 Compose simple melodies.

Suggested Methodology: Demonstration, Discussion...

Learning Environment Setup: Any, such as natural (any outdoor environment...) artificial (music room...) and technological (video, online research ...)

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Piano/keyboard, guitar ...



LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Activity 1: Discussing motif in melody writing.

Task 1: Engage learners in small groups and discuss what a motif is in melody writing.



TIP

Play or sing a well-known melody that features a motif and ask learners to identify and discuss motif in the melody.



DISCUSSION

- In smaller groups learners study and identify the motifs below:



TIP

Highlight major features of the motif for each melody below

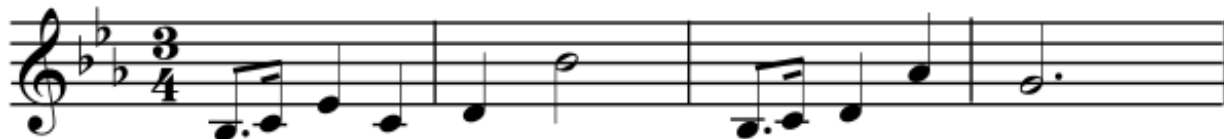
Conjunct



Disjunct



Mixed



- Learners give examples of motifs from songs of their choices.
- With learners, analyse the motifs given as examples.

Activity 2: Distinguishing various phrases in the melody (antecedent /question, consequent / answer)

Task 1:



DISCUSSION

- Ask learners to discuss what a phrase is and how to distinguish it in a melody.
- Learners distinguish between an antecedent /question and consequent /answer in a given melody.

**TIP**

Encourage exploration among learners by asking them to distinguish between a question and an answer in a melody. This can either be done in groups or individually.

- Remind learners that just as they often pause between the different sections in a sentence (for example, when you say, “wherever you go, there you are”), a melody usually pauses slightly at the end of each phrase.
- Emphasis should be made that in vocal music, the musical phrases tend to follow the phrases and sentences of the text.

Examples of Antecedent phrases and consequent phrases

The melody for “Mary Had a Little Lamb” is a well -known example of a simple melody.

The antecedent phrase in the melody is:

“Ma-ry had a lit-tle Lamb”

This phrase sets up the expectation for the consequent phrase which completes the musical thought:

“Lit-tle lamb, lit-tle lamb”

Mary Had a Little Lamb

Traditional



In the melody “Mary Had a Little Lamb”, possible motif can be identified as:

“Ma-ry had”

This short melodic idea (3-4 notes) is repeated and varied throughout the melody, making it a motif.

Here is a breakdown:

- “Ma-ry had” (motif)
- “alit-tle lamb” (variation of the motif)

- “Lit-tle lamb, lit-tle lamb (repetition and variation of the motif)

This motif is then developed and expanded upon to create the complete melody.

Activity 3: Composing Simple Melodies (At least four bars...)

Task 1:

- In smaller groups learners to compose a simple four bar melody.



TIP

- Note that when composing a melody, the following points should be considered:
 - i. Time signature and key signature,
 - ii. On which scale degree and beat of the bar does the melody begin?
 - iii. What rhythmic patterns are to be used?
 - iv. Maintain the motif to be used in the melody, and where possible variety it.
 - v. Provide a consequent to the antecedent.
 - vi. Sing or hum while composing the melody to internalize it.
 - vii. End on the tonic with a long note and approach it in stepwise motion and avoid unnecessary wide leaps.

Expected Standard: Simple melodies composed accordingly.



ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

- In smaller groups, learners to complete provided melodies to ‘four’ bars by writing a consequent phrase.
- In pairs, learners create and vary a simple melodic motif within four bars.
- Individually learners compose a ‘four’ melody in any key of their choice.
- Sight sing or sight read the composed melodies



SUMMARY

- Simple melody writing (composing) refers to the process or technique of creating a short, coherent, and memorable musical idea using pitch and rhythm, to convey emotion and mood.
- A phrase is a unit of a musical thought that consists of a group of notes that form a coherent and meaningful musical idea.
- An antecedent phrase is the first phrase in a pair of phrases, typically followed by a consequent phrase.
- A melody is made up of phrases, which are usually two or four bars long
- When composing simple melodies one should consider all necessary steps.
- A motif can be, melodic or rhythmic (or it may contain a combination of the two elements) and is considered to be the smallest of the ‘building blocks’ – the recognisable, reoccurring themes and phrases – that make up a composition

1.6 TOPIC: FORM

Introduction

Form in music refers to the overall structure or organization of a piece of music. It encompasses the arrangement of musical elements such as melody, harmony, rhythm, and tempo to create a cohesive and meaningful whole. Form is very important because it gives music a clear beginning, middle, and end, making it easier to follow and understand. Form allows composers to create contrast between different sections of music, adding variety and interest.

General competence(s)

Learners should acquire the following general competences:

Analytical thinking: Ability to systematically examine, interpret and evaluate musical elements and structures, for purpose of applying them in addressing social- economical needs.

Critical thinking: Ability to analyse, investigate and evaluate musical works, performances and practices with a discerning and reflective mindset to address social-economical needs.

Communication: Ability to express and convey musical ideas appropriately, clearly and effectively (verbal and non- verbal)

Collaboration: Ability to work effectively with others in various musical setting such as ensembles or bands and other music projects to achieve goals in musical arts Education.

Creativity and innovation: Ability to experiment new approaches and generate musical ideas that exhibit originality and take creative risks in the composition, performance and interpretation of music.



TERMINOLOGY

Binary Form: A simple musical structure consisting of two contrasting sections (AB)

Ternary Form: A musical structure consisting of three sections, with the first and third sections being similar (ABA)

Theme: A recurring melody or idea

Section: A distinct part of the music, often with its own unique characteristics

Transition: A passage connecting two sections.

Rhythm: This is the arrangement of sounds in time, creating a sense of pulse, meter and groove.

Melody: Is a succession of pitches heard in sequence, creating a musical line.

Sequence: A repetition pattern of pitches at a higher or lower level.

Repetition: Repeating a melodic idea or pattern

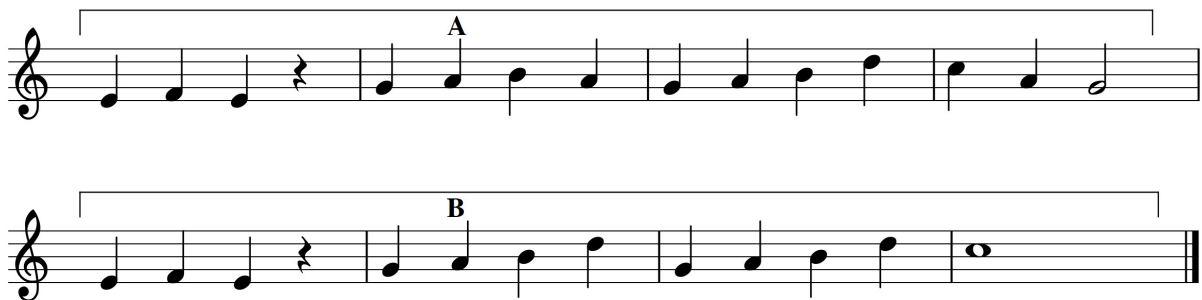
Variation: Changing a melodic idea or pattern while maintaining its core identity.

1.6.1 Sub-topic: Binary and ternary**Introduction**

Binary form is one of the simplest and most common musical forms, used in a wide range of musical styles and genres. It is a fundamental concept in music theory, and understanding binary form helps one analyse and appreciate the structure of many musical compositions. Binary form consists of two contrasting sections, often labeled as A and B. The A section typically presents a theme or melody, while the B section presents a contrasting theme or develops the initial theme. The two sections are usually of equal or approximately equal length.

Ternary form on the other hand, is a musical structure consisting of three main sections, typically represented as A-B-A. This means the piece begins with an initial theme or section (A), followed by a contrasting middle section (B), and concludes with a return to the initial theme or section (A). Ternary form provides a sense of balance and symmetry, making it a popular choice for composers and songwriters.

Example of Binary form



Ternary Form ABA



Specific competence: 1.6.1.1 Construct melody in binary and ternary forms

Suggested Methodology: Demonstration, group and individual activities...



LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Learning environment setup: You can teach the learners from any of the environments such as natural (any outdoor environment...), artificial (music room...) and technological (video...)

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Piano/Keyboard, blue tooth speaker, projectors, and visual aids such as charts...

Activity 1: Detecting rhythmic and melodic contrast

Task 1: Ask learners to listen, sing or play simple melodies like “Baba Black sheep” and identify rhythmic and melodic contrast.



TIP

Promote analytical thinking by allowing learners to listen, sing or play simple melodies and identify rhythmic and melodic contrast.

Task 2: Play a melody with a contrasting contour or rhythm and ask learners to imitate it. Then, ask them to create their own melody.



TIP

Encourage creativity among the learners by asking them to create their own melody with a contrasting contour. This can either be written or performed (singing or instrument playing)

Task 3: Provide learners with a score or recording a piece. Ask them to analyse the form, identifying areas of contrast and unity.



TIP

Provide each learner with a score and then allow them to analyse the form of the given song identifying areas of contrast and unity.

Activity 2: Constructing sections of equal length of binary and ternary structure

Task 1: Ask learners to compose a short piece in binary or ternary form ensuring each section A and B or A, B and A have the equal number of measures (4 measures each)



TIP

Put learners in groups so that they work as a team and later on allow them to do the work individually. Encourage critical thinking and creativity as they work on this activity.

Task 2: Class discussion on the characteristics of binary and ternary forms. Ask learners to share their compositions and provide feedback on section length and contrast.



TIP

Facilitate a class discussion on the characteristics of binary and ternary forms. Ensure that each learner is fully involved in the discussion.

Activity 3: Constructing sections of unequal length in binary and ternary design.

Task 1: Ask learners to compose a binary form piece (AB) with sections of unequal length (e.g., 4 measures in A and 6 measures in B) or Ask them to compose a ternary form piece (ABA) with sections of unequal length (e.g., 4 measures in A, 6 measures in B and 4 measures in A).



TIP

Ensure that the constructed measures are not equal.

Task 2: Provide learners with a partially completed binary or ternary form piece. Ask them to expand one section (e.g., add 4 measures to section A in binary form) or expand the middle section (B) in ternary form while maintaining the outer sections' length.



TIP

Ensure that the suggested sections for binary and ternary forms are expanded as expected.

Task 3: Give learners a score in binary or ternary form with unequal length. Ask them to identify and label the sections.



TIP

Ensure that learners are able to identify and label the sections. Guide the learners throughout the lesson.

Expected standard: Melodies in binary and ternary form constructed correctly



ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Prepare tasks to be administered during and after learning sessions and give carry home tasks.

- Form and analysis – Analyse and identify the form of provided melodies
- Written and practical assessment (composing and performing melodies in binary or ternary form).



SUMMARY

This topic has highlighted the following:

- Musical form refers to the overall structure or organization of a piece of music.
- Binary is a simple musical structure with two sections while ternary is a simple musical structure with three sections.
- Form is shaped by theme, section, transition, development and repetition.

TOPIC: 1.7 MUSICAL TERMS AND SIGNS

Introduction

Musical terms and signs are specialized words and symbols used in music notation to convey information about pitch, rhythm, dynamics, articulation, and other aspects of musical performance. Musical terms and signs are important in that they help musicians read music fluently, play expressively and perform pieces accurately.

There are so many musical terms and signs used in music, as such this topic will not cover all of them. This topic is broken down into two subtopics which are: Italian terms that deal with interpreting tempo and dynamics.

General Competences:

Learners should acquire the following general Competences:

Analytical thinking: Ability to systematically examine, interpret and evaluate musical elements and structures, for purpose of applying them in addressing social-economical needs.

Creativity and innovation: Ability to experiment new approaches and generate musical ideas that exhibit originality and take creative risks in the composition, performance and interpretation of music.

Critical thinking: Ability to analyse, investigate and evaluate musical works, performances and practices with a discerning and reflective mindset to address social-economical needs.

Collaboration: Ability to work effectively with others in various musical setting such as ensembles or bands and other music projects to achieve goals in Musical Arts Education.

Communication: Ability to express and convey musical ideas appropriately, clearly and effectively (verbal and non-verbal).

Emotional intelligence: Ability to recognise, understand, express and manage emotional stress in oneself and others through musical activities.

Problem solving: Ability to use music to identify, analyse and address social-economic challenges and obstacles.



TERMINOLOGY

Below are some of the terminologies Interpreting the Italian terms for tempo:

Accelerando (accel.): Getting quicker

Adagio: Leisurely – usually quite slow

Adagietto: Slow, gentle tempo

Allegretto: Moderate, playful tempo

Allegro: (cheerful) fast

Andante: (easy going) At a walking pace

Andantino: Not as slow as andante

A tempo: Returning to the original tempo after a deviation

Grave: Usually very slow

Larghetto: Slow, lyrical tempo, rather broadly

Largo: Very slow, dignified tempo

Lento: Slow tempo, slower than largo

Moderato: Moderate tempo (moderately)

Presto: Very fast

Ritardando: (rit) holding back

Scherzo: Fast, lively

Vivace: Full of life, fast, lively tempo.

Sub-Topic: 1.7.1 Italian Terms

Introduction

Most musical terms are written in Italian Language because of the country's significant contributions to the development of Western classical music. Italian composers were the first to write 'instruction' words at certain points in their music. Italian musical terms have become an integral part of the language of music, providing a universal vocabulary for musicians to communicate and interpret music accurately.

The term 'tempo' is derived from the Italian language. In Italian, 'tempo' means 'time' and in music, it refers to the speed or rate at which a piece of music is performed.

Specific Competence 1.7.1 .1. Interpret the Italian terms for tempo.

Suggested Methodology: Demonstration, Discussion...

Learning Environment Setup: Any environment such as, (any outdoor), artificial (music room...) and technological (video, YouTube)

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Piano/keyboard, guitars, visual aids such as charts...



LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Activity 1: Interpreting the Italian terms for tempo (allegro, presto, lento ...)

Task 1: Divide learners in groups and give them a musical score sheet with Italian terms. Ask them to interpret as well as demonstrate how the music will be performed.



TIPS

- Engage learners to perform popular music (songs) and apply different tempo.
- Learners to listen to piece of different tempo.

Expected Standard: Italian terms for tempo interpreted correctly.

Specific competence: 1.7.1.2. Interpret the Italian terms for dynamics.

Activity: 2. Interpreting the Italian terms for dynamics piano (*p*), forte (*f*)...



DISCUSSION

to be done in groups.

Task 1 Divide learners in groups and give them a musical score sheet with Italian terms for dynamics. Ask them to interpret as well as demonstrate how the music will be performed.



TIP

- Engage learners to interpret the Italian terms for dynamics and help them demonstrate how they are applied either by singing or playing instruments as prescribed; (Soft, loud...)

Below are some of the commonly used Italian terms for dynamics:

- **Main dynamic markings:**
 1. Pianissimo (pp): Very soft
 2. Piano (p): Soft
 3. Mezzo -piano (mp): Moderately soft
 4. Mezzo-forte (mf) moderately loud
 5. Forte (f): Loud
 6. Fortissimo: (ff) Very loud
- **Gradual Dynamic Changes:**
 1. Crescendo (cresc): Gradually getting louder.
 2. Decrescendo (decrec: Gradually getting softer.
 3. Diminuendo (dim) getting softer.
 4. Rinforzando (rfz): Gradually getting louder and stronger
- **Sudden Dynamic Changes:**
 1. Sforzando (sfz): Sudden, strong accent.
 2. Sforzato (sf): Sudden, strong accent (similar to sforzando).
 3. Subito: Sudden change in dynamics (e.g, subito piano for sudden softening.)

Expected Standard: Italian terms for dynamics interpreted correctly.



ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Prepare tasks to be administered during and after learning sessions and give carry home tasks.

- Sight reading/singing.
- Playing instruments.
- Listening and analysis.
- Written work.



SUMMARY

This subtopic has highlighted the following:

- Musical terms and signs are specialized words and symbols used in music notation to convey information.
- Italian composers were the first to write ‘instruction’ words to music as such Italian musical terms have become an integral part of the language of music.
- Tempo refers to the speed or rate at which a piece of music is performed.
- In music, dynamics refer to the varying degrees of loudness and softness in a musical composition. It describes the contrast between quiet and loud sounds, which adds expression, emotion, and depth to the music. By varying dynamics, musicians add feeling to their performance, making music engaging and impactful to the listener.

Sub-Topic: 1.7.2. Musical Signs

Introduction

Musical signs also known as musical notation symbols, are graphical representations used to convey musical information. They help musicians read and interpret musical score.

Specific Competence 1.7.2.1. Demonstrate musical signs in music composition

Suggested Methodology: Demonstration, group and individual activities ...

Learning Environment Setup: Any environment such as, (any outdoor), artificial (music room...) and technological (video, YouTube)

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Piano/keyboard, guitars, visual aids such as charts...



LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Activity 1: Identifying music signs (staccato, legato, repeat signs...)

Task 1: Learners in groups to identify music signs (staccato, legato, repeat signs...) on a music score provided like the one below.



**TIPS**

Guide the learners to explore and identify music signs (staccato, legato, repeat signs...) on a music score provided.

Activity 2: Demonstrating music signs

Task 1: Perform melodies in groups demonstrating (staccato, legato, repeat signs...) on a music score provided.

**TIPS**

Facilitate group performances to help learners demonstrate (staccato, legato, repeat signs...)

Expected Standard: Musical signs demonstrated appropriately

**ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**

Prepare tasks to be administered during and after learning sessions and give carry home tasks.

- Sight reading/singing.
- Playing instruments.
- Listening and analysis.
- Written work (composition)

**SUMMARY**

- The word staccato comes from the Italian word meaning “detached” or “disconnected,” which means to play notes short and sharply, with a slight silence between each note. It is indicated by a small dot (.) placed either above or below the note head, signifying that the note should be played short and detached.
- Legato is an Italian term meaning tied together. Legato is a performance technique used in music. It creates a smooth, steady flow between notes. Every single note is played to its utmost length and then harmonizes straight into the following note, allowing a better crescendo or decrescendo of the phrase.
- In music, a repeat sign is symbol that indicate a section of music should be repeated.

TOPIC 1.8 HARMONY

Introduction

In music, Harmony refers to the combination of different musical notes played or sung at the same time to produce a pleasing sound. It usually supports the melody (the tune) and adds depth, emotion and texture to a piece of music.

Harmony is created when two or more notes sound together, forming chords (like C major or G minor), or more complex structures. For instance, if someone sings or plays a melody and another person sings or plays a different note that blends well with it, they are singing or playing in harmony. So when we think of Harmony, we are thinking of layers of sound.

It is a fundamental aspect of music, enhancing the emotional impact and aesthetic appeal of a composition.

General Competences:

Analytical thinking: Ability to systematically examine, interpret and evaluate musical elements and structures, for the purpose of applying them in social-economic needs.

Collaboration: Ability to work effectively with others in various musical settings such as ensembles or bands and other music projects to achieve goals in Musical Arts Education.

Creativity and Innovation: Ability to experiment new approaches and generate musical ideas that exhibit originality and take risks in the composition, performance and interpretation of music.

Critical thinking: Ability to analyse, investigate and evaluate musical works, performances and practices with a discerning and reflective mindset to address social-economical needs.

Digital Literacy: Ability to effectively use hardware and software to analyse, create, produce, and share music.

Problem solving: Ability to use music to identify, analyse and address social-economical challenges and obstacles.



TERMINOLOGY

Cadence: A chord progression that signals the end of a phrase or section. (perfect cadence (V-I).

Chord: Is formed when two or more different notes are played or sung together. The most common is a Triad, which consists of 3 notes (C-E-G).

Chord progression: Is a sequence of chords played in successions. (I - IV - V - I)

Consonance: A combination of notes that sounds stable, pleasant or resolved.

Dissonance: A combination of notes that sounds tense or unstable; often used to create drama or resolution.

Interval: The distance between two notes. Common intervals include 2nd, 3rd, 5th and Octaves.

Inversion: A chord where the root is not the lowest note. Changes the feel/sound of the chord.

Key: The tonal center or home scale of a piece, which determines which chords are most commonly used

Triad: A basic three-note chord made of root, third and fifth. (D minor triad=D-F-A.)

Voicing: Exploring different ways to arrange notes in chords can lead to fuller or more varied sound such as using inversions.

Subtopic:1.8.1 Triads

Introduction

A triad is a three-note chord built from a root, third and fifth. It is a group of three notes played or sung simultaneously.

When we refer to the root, third and fifth, we mean that:

- The root is a base note (foundation note).
- The third is a third interval above the root.
- The fifth is a fifth note (a perfect 5th) above the root.

Specific competences: 1.8.1.1 Construct triads

Suggested Methodology: Discussion, Demonstration, individual...

Learning environment setup: Any environment such as, (any outdoor), artificial (music room...) and technological (video...).

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Piano, keyboard, guitars, charts...

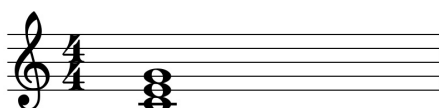


LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Identifying triads (Root, 3rd and 5th).

Activity 1: Identifying triads (roots, third and fifth).

Task 1: Ask learners to identify and label the triads as root, third and fifth on a staff using the tonic triad in C major.



G - 5th
E - 3rd
C - Root



TIP

- Facilitate learners' involvement in identifying and labelling the triads as root, third and fifth.



DISCUSSION

- Break learners into smaller groups to discuss and identify the triads as root, third and fifth.

Task 2: Ask learners to either sing or play the constructed tonic triad in C major.



TIP

Allow learners in groups to freely explore and experiment by either singing or playing the tonic triad in C major.

Activity 2: Constructing triads (root, 3rd, 5th)

Task 1: Engage learners in constructing triads (root, 3rd, 5th) on the staff in different keys.



TIP

- Engage and support learners in constructing triads (root, 5th, 3rd) on either treble or bass staff.

Expected standard: Triads constructed correctly.



ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Prepare tasks to be administered during and after learning sessions and give carry home tasks.

- Identify, construct and play/sing the triads given.
- Create a quiz to test learners' ability to identify triads.
- Assign a project where learners analyse and identify triads in selected score.
- Give short answer questions by asking students to explain triad concepts and give musical examples.
- Ask learners to compose short pieces of music using triads.

Activity 3: Describing triads (major, minor, diminished or augmented).

Task 1: Ask learners to describe triads as (major, minor, diminished or augmented).



TIP

- Introduce the theoretical and practical application of triads as (major, minor, diminished or augmented).



- Introduce the basics of triads-a triad is a three-note chord built from a root, 3rd and 5th.

- Guide learners how to identify intervals in a triad e.g. Major 3rd which has 3 steps with 4 semitones – (C to E) and minor 3rd has 3 steps with 3 semitones (C to E flat...)
- Major triad –structure is root +major third +perfect fifth
- Minor triad structure has root + minor third + perfect.

Activity 4: Inverting triads.

Teaching inverting triads involves a structured approach that helps learners understand the concept of triads, their inversions and how to identify and perform them.

Task 1: Invert triads from root position to first and second inversion.



TIPS

- Guide learners on how to invert triads from root, first and second inversion.
- Provide worksheets where learners must label triads and their inversions in musical notation.
- Have learners practice performing triads and their inversions on their instruments.
- Start with simple major and minor triads before moving to diminished and augmented.

Activity 5: Playing triads.

Task 1: Perform each type of triad (Major, minor, diminished and augmented) on an instrument (piano, guitar...)



TIPS

- Guide learners how to play triads on an instrument
- Give learners a root note and have them play the third and the fifth notes.
- Engage learners in ear training by identifying the played triads (Major, minor...)
- Comparative listening-guide: learners to play in pairs e.g. major vs minor and have students describe emotional quality of each.

Specific competence: 1.8.1.2 Apply primary and secondary triads

Suggested Methodology: Discussion, Demonstration, individual...

Learning environment setup: Any environment such as, (any outdoor), artificial (music room...) and technological (video...).

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Piano, keyboard, guitars, charts...



LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Activity 1: Identifying primary and secondary triads in any given scale.

Task 1: Learners to identify primary and secondary triads in groups in any given scale.



TIP

Carefully guide learners how to identify primary and secondary triads in any given scale.

Activity 2: Applying primary and secondary triads in any given scale.

Task 1: Learners construct primary and secondary triads in any given scale/key.



TIP

- Guide learners how to construct primary and secondary triads in any given key/scale.

Expected standard: Primary and secondary triads in any given scale applied correctly.



ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Prepare tasks to be administered during and after learning sessions and give carry home tasks.

- Create a quiz to test learners' ability to understand primary and secondary triads in any given key/scale.
- Assign a project where learners analyse and identify primary and secondary triads in any given key/scale.
- Ask learners to create and notate simple chord progressions of primary and secondary triads in any given key/scale.



SUMMARY

This topic has highlighted the following:

- Harmony refers to the combination of different musical notes played or sung at the same time to produce a pleasing sound.
- A triad is a three-note chord built from a root, third and fifth. It is a group of three notes played or sung simultaneously.

When we refer to the root, third and fifth, we mean that:

- The root is a base note (foundation note).
- The third is a third interval above the root.
- The fifth is a fifth note (a perfect 5th) above the root.

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Appendix: SAMPLE LESSON PLAN TEMPLATE

SCHOOL: _____

NAME OF TEACHER: _____ **DATE:** _____

CLASS: _____ **DURATION:** _____

TOTAL ENROLLMENT: BOYS _____ **GIRLS** _____ **TIME:** _____

TOTAL ATTENDANCE: BOYS _____ **GIRLS** _____

SUBJECT: _____

TOPIC: _____ *(This must come from the syllabus with its serial number)*

SUB-TOPIC: _____ *(This must come from the syllabus with its serial number)*

GENERAL COMPETENCES: _____

SPECIFIC COMPETENCES: _____ *(This must come from the syllabus with its serial number)*

RATIONALE: _____

PRIOR KNOWLEDGE: _____

REFERENCES: _____

LEARNING ENVIRONMENT

Natural environment: _____

Artificial environment: _____

Technological environment: _____

TEACHING AND LEARNING MATERIALS/RESOURCES: _____

EXPECTED STANDARD: _____

(This must come from the syllabus as it is)

LESSON PROGRESSION:

STAGES	TEACHER'S ACTIVITIES	LEARNERS' ACTIVITIES	ASSESSMENT CRITERIA
INTRODUCTION 5 Minutes			
LESSON DEVELOP- MENT 5 Minutes			
15 Minutes			
15 Minutes			
EXERCISE /APPLICA- TION 20 Minutes			
CONCLUSION 10 Minutes			

HOMEWORK: _____

LESSON EVALUATION:

Appendix: SAMPLE LESSON PLAN

SCHOOL: BROADWAY SECONDARY

NAME OF TEACHER: TINA KAPAMPA CHINYAMA

DATE: 18TH APRIL, 2025

CLASS: FORM 1 M

DURATION: 80 MINUTES

TOTAL ENROLLMENT: BOYS: 25 GIRLS: 30

TIME: 07: 30 HOURS- 08:50 HOURS

TOTAL ATTENDANCE: BOYS: 25 GIRLS: 30

SUBJECT: MUSICAL ARTS EDUCATION

TOPIC: 1.8 HARMONY

SUB-TOPIC: TRIADS

GENERAL COMPETENCES: Analytical thinking, Collaboration, Creativity and Innovation, Critical thinking, Digital thinking and Problem solving.

SPECIFIC COMPETENCES: 1.8.1.1 Construct triads

RATIONALE: This lesson will focus on constructing triads which is a fundamental skill in music theory, designed to help learners recognise and appreciate harmony in music. In this lesson, learners will acquire a skill in constructing triads through demonstration, discussion, and group work and think pair. Understanding how to build triads, empowers learners to create their own music and apply harmony in a real life situation. This lesson is lesson 1 in a series of 7.

PRIOR KNOWLEDGE: **Pitch, Intervals and Melody** (basic music notation, scale knowledge staff notation, note reading, note names and positions, basic chord concept, note values and rests)

REFERENCES:

- 2025 Musical Arts Education Form 1- Teaching Module page 33.
- Harmony theory- James e. Perone page 55.
- WWW.youtube video on Triads.

LEARNING ENVIRONMENT

Natural environment: (any outdoor)

Artificial environment/ Technological environment: (music room...) and technological (video...)

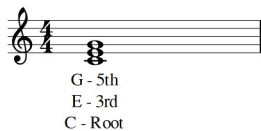
TEACHING AND LEARNING MATERIALS/RESOURCES: Piano, keyboard, guitars, charts...

EXPECTED STANDARD: **Triads constructed correctly.** *(It will only be exhausted upon completion of all the lined up activities)*

(This must come from the syllabus as it is)

LESSON PROGRESSION

STAGES	TEACHER'S ACTIVITIES	LEARNERS' ACTIVITIES	ASSESSMENT CRITERIA
INTRODUCTION 5 Minutes	● Divide learners into three groups and assign sol-fa syllables to each group (Do, Mi and So). Ask them to build the 3rd and 5th on each sol-fa respectively. ● Explain what a triad is (refer to notes in the Module and other prepared notes)	● Build the 3rd and 5th to the assigned sol-fa syllables.	● Observe learner engagement and participation
LESSON DEVELOPMENT 10 Minutes	● Discuss with learners how to identify a triad.	Activity 1 Ask learners to identify and label the triads as root, third and fifth on a staff using the tonic triad in C major.	● Assess understanding of a Triad. ● Assess learners' ability to identify and label the triads as root, third and fifth on a staff using the tonic triad in C major.
15 Minutes	● Demonstrate with learners how to construct a triad (root, 3rd and 5th positions) on the staff, and on the keyboard.	Activity 2 Constructing triads, (root, 3 rd , 5 th)	● Evaluate the learner's ability to construct triads (root, 3rd and 5th positions) focussing on: ● Accuracy of constructing a triad. ● Understanding the formation of triads and their characteristics.

EXERCISE /APPLICATION 20 Minutes	● Ask learners to identify and label the triads as root, third and fifth on a staff.	Task 1: ● Identifying and labelling the triads as root, third and fifth on a staff using the tonic triad in C major.  G - 5th E - 3rd C - Root	● Assess learners' ability to identify and label the triads as root, third and fifth on a staff.
20 Minutes	● Engage learners in constructing triads (root, 3rd, 5th) on the staff in different keys.	Task 2: construct triads in (root, 3rd, 5th) on the staff in different keys.	Assess learner's ability to construct triads in (root, 3rd, 5th) on the staff in different keys, focussing on: ● Exploration of different scale degrees. ● Creativity in construction
CONCLUSION 10 Minutes	Review key concepts: ● What a triad is. ● Identification of triads. ● Learners reflect on what they learnt on construction of triads.	Sharing reflections and insights on: ● What a triad is. ● Identification of triads. ● Learners reflect on what they learnt on construction of triads.	Evaluate learners' understanding of what a triad is, identification of triads and constructing of triads. ● Suggest areas of improvement.

HOMEWORK: Learners to construct triads in (root, 3rd, 5th) on the staff in G major.

LESSON EVALUATION:

Learners were able to construct triads in root, 3rd and 5th positions by applying critical and analytical thinking in identifying different triads. However, five learners experienced difficulty in reading staff notation which slowed down triad construction. There is need to revisit basic note reading and intervals in the next lesson to reinforce foundation.